María **Grandury**

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Natural Language Processing Researcher

Education (465 ECTS)

2026 PhD, **Computer Science**, École Polytechnique Fédérale de Lausanne (EPFL), Switzerland - Thesis (**Multilingual Multicultural LLM Evaluation**), advised by Assistant Prof. Antoine Bosselut.

2025 MS, **Language Technologies**, National University of Distance Education (UNED), Spain - Thesis (**LLM Evaluation**) : *Multicultural LLM evaluation : The case of Spanish as a pluricentric language*, collaboration with EPFL.

2020 BS, **Mathematics**, Oviedo University, Spain, - Thesis (**Algebra**) : *Algebraic algorithms and their applications to Deep Learning*, implemented a COVID-19 chatbot with 92% 1st turn acc. used by 1500+ persons during the pandemic.

2020 BS, **Physics**, Oviedo University, Spain, - Thesis (**Particle Physics**) : *Study of the processes involving top quarks and the Higgs boson in the CMS detector at the Large Hadron Collider (LHC) at CERN using Neural Networks.*

2019 1-year exchange, Paris-Saclay University (prev. Paris-Sud), France

Non-Profit & Research Experience

Today – Mar 2021 | **Founder & President , SomosNLP.org**, Non-profit, Spain & LATAM

- Founded the **largest community of Spanish-speaking open-source NLP practitioners** with 2000+ members.
- Led the collaboration between 10 research groups to collect 60+ evaluation datasets in 4 languages to implement the **first open generative LLM leaderboard in the languages from LATAM and Spain**, "La Leaderboard".
- Led the organization of 5 editions of an international online hackathon focused on creating open-source Spanish NLP resources. In total : 2000+ registrations, 60+ speakers & mentors, 100+ datasets & models created.
- Led the creation of an open-source NLP from zero to hero course in Spanish with 45k visualizations.
- Inaugurated the **Hugging Face Fellowship**, awarded for these contributions to the open-source ecosystem.

Jun 2026 – Jan 2026 | **Researcher, Spanish General Direction of Artificial Intelligence (DGIA)**, Part-time, Spain

- Technical lead of the development of a portal for all AI resources, events, and communications in Spain.

Jun 2026 – Nov 2025 | **Researcher, National University of Distance Education (UNED)**, Part-time, Spain

- Lead a data collection initiative to evaluate the cultural adequacy of LLMs with Spanish-speaking countries.

Nov 2025 – Sep 2024 | **Researcher, Technical University of Madrid (UPM)**, Part-time, Spain

- Co-lead a 40.000 € project to evaluate the **climate impact of LLMs funded by COTEC #PIA Under 30**.
- Designed and analyzed methods to evaluate **LLM's Spanish proficiency and Spanish varieties adequacy**.
- Conducted **psycholinguistic** experiments to study the correlation between familiarity, synesthesia, iconicity, and anxiety in humans and LLMs together with Prof. Marc Brysbaert from Ghent University.
- Lead the collaboration with the National Program of Green Algorithms (PNAV) to define the **national climate impact standards and a quality seal**. Contributing to the organization of a 4-month GreenAI hackathon.
- Responsible for the **GenAI MOOC courses on ethics, alignment** with human values, and the Spanish SOTA.

Jul 2025 – May 2025 | **Visiting Student, École Polytechnique Fédérale de Lausanne (EPFL)**, Switzerland

- Co-created a +100 language-region pairs **multicultural benchmark**, leading the LATAM data collection.
- Implemented benchmarks to evaluate the open-source multilingual Large Language Model "Apertus".

Publications (Selected, * First Author)

- * La Leaderboard : A LLM Leaderboard for Spanish Varieties and Languages of Spain and Latin America. **ACL Main**, 2025.
- * INCLUDE-2.0 : Disentangling Knowledge Gaps in Multilingual LLM Evaluation. **EMNLP Main**, 2026.
- * Spanish as a Pluricentric Lang. : Challenging the Monolingual Bias in NLP to Improve Cultural Adequacy. *COLM-MELT*, 2025.
- * The #Somos600M Project : NLP resources that represent the diversity of the languages from LATAM. *NAACL-LXAI*, 2024.
- Adding LLMs to the psycholinguistic norming toolbox. *Behavior Research Methods, 58, 253*, 2026.
- Measuring what Matters : Construct Validity in Large Language Model Benchmarks. *NeurIPS*, 2025.
- It's the same but not the same : Do LLMs distinguish Spanish varieties ? *Procesamiento del Lenguaje Natural, 75, 137-146*, 2025.
- Spanish and LLM Benchmarks : Is MMLU lost in translation ? *GACLM*, 2025.
- Kaleidoscope : In-language Exams for Massively Multilingual Vision Evaluation, *ICLR*, 2025.
- Evaluating large language models with tests of Spanish as a foreign language : Pass or fail ? *Applied Linguistics*, 2026.
- Publications presenting pretrained LLMs : Apertus (ACL 2026), BLOOM (2022), BERTIN (SEPLN 2022)

Teaching and Public Speaking Experience (Selected)

- **Swiss Embassy in Spain**, *"Why and how to develop open-source multilingual AI" @EUNIC Science Day*, talk, Jun 2026
- **Basque Government**, talk, *"Sovereign AI in Switzerland : What is possible today. The case of Apertus."*, Jun 2026
- **Secretaría de Estado de Digitalización e IA** (SEDIA), round table, *"Challenges of Ethical and Cultural Alignment"*, Mar 2026
- **Secretaría de Estado de Digitalización e Inteligencia Artificial** (SEDIA), round table, *"Aterrizando la IA a la realidad"*, Dec 2025
- **Ministerio de Cultura | XI Encuentro de Cultura y Ciudadanía**, *"Intersecciones críticas : IA, sesgos y subjetividades"*, Oct 2025
- **Galician Supercomputing Center** (CESGA), 8h workshop, *"Fundamentals of NLP for small business CTOs"*, Sep 2025
- **National University of Asunción, Paraguay** (UNA), 25h undergrad module, *"Deep Learning for NLP"*, Sep 2025
- **Ministry of Culture, Spain**, round table moderator, *"Critical intersection : AI, biases, and subjectivity"*, Sep 2025.
- **International University of Andalucía** (UNIA), 5h summer school workshop, *"Responsible NLP"*, Aug 2023-25
- **National Center of Artificial Intelligence** (CENIA), 4h undergrad masterclass, *"RLHF & Model Alignment"*, Apr 2025
- **University of Chile** (UChile), talk, *"How to impulse the development of LLMs in Spanish"*, Apr 2025
- **Mohamed bin Zayed University of Artificial Intelligence** (MBZUAI), talk, *"Promoting inclusive NLP"*, Feb 2025
- **National Autonomous University of Mexico** (UNAM), 5h undergrad masterclass, *"LLM evaluation & synthetic data"*, Dec 2024
- **Université Côte d'Azur**, EFELIA hackathon opening keynote, *"Open-Source Responsible AI with Hugging Face"*, Nov 2024
- **University of Puerto Rico**, *"Open-source and linguistic diversity in AI : Impulsing the future of Spanish from university"*, Mar 2024

Professional Experience

Nov 2023 – Jun 2023 | **Machine Learning Engineer, Clibrain**, Full-time, Madrid, Spain
- **Designed the evaluation strategy of the startup** and transformed it into a proposal for a European project.
- Led the evaluation of the proprietary LLMs' performance and bias. Created a Spanish equivalent of MTBench.
- Designed and implemented the internal dataset collection, creation & annotation pipeline.
- Contributed as Advisor (Jun-Jul) to the development of LINCE, a state-of-the-art (Jun 2023) Spanish LLM.

Jul 2023 – Feb 2021 | **Research Engineer, neurocat**, Full-time, Berlin, Germany
- **Core maintainer of the startup's internal product for ML model robustness and explainability assessment.**
- Designed the product's support for NLP models and led agile sprints to implement it. Implemented SOTA explainability methods (e.g. SHAP) and adversarial attacks (e.g. backdoors) to assess NLP & CV models' safety.

Jun 2020 – Apr 2020 | **Machine Learning Engineer, REDYTEL WIMAX**, Internship, Remote, Spain
- Developed a **chatbot** on AWS that understands correctly on the 1st attempt 91% of the 500+ questions/month the clients ask it, reducing the calls to customer service by 25%. S3 database with clients from 1500+ towns.

Aug 2019 – Jun 2019 | **Software Engineer, Stelliant**, Internship, Paris, France
- Built an AWS serverless **chatbot** using Angular and Node.js that allows each client to access confidential information about the status of their case and attach documents. End-to-end agile project management.

Jul 2018 – Jun 2018 | **Data Analyst, Sociedad Asturiana de Estudios Económicos e Industriales (SADEI)**, Internship, Oviedo, Spain
- Created algorithms to analyze 78.000+ companies' data and **optimize** the commuting of their employees.

Achievements

- **40.000€ COTEC #PIA Under 30 Fund**, co-lead, 2024-25
- **Hugging Face Fellowship**, open-source contrib., 2021-
- **Fatima Fellowship**, open research program, 2024-25
- **15.600€ Spanish Entrepreneurship Fund**, 2024-26
- Interviewed by Spain's #1 newspaper "El País", 2024-
- Interviewed by Spain's #1 radio "Cadena SER", 2024
- Nova, Global Top Talent Network, 2020 -
- **Honour Mention BS Mathematics Thesis**, 9.5/10, 2020
- High School, highest distinction, GPA : 9.7/10, 2011-15
- Music Conservatory, GPA : 8/10, 1st oboe, 2005-15
- Internationales Preisträgerprogramm - IPP, 2014
- ESTALMAT Mathematical Talent Stimulation, 2009-13

Open-Source Projects

- **INCLUDE Benchmark**, Spain & LATAM Lang. Lead, 2025
- **LATAM-GPT**, latamgpt.org, Researcher, contributing to the data, alignment and evaluation teams, 2024 -
- **FineWeb2**, Spain & LATAM Language Lead, 2025
- **Data is Better Together**, Spain & LATAM Lead, 2024 -
- AYA by Cohere For AI, Spanish Ambassador, 2024
- The Great Spanish Instructions Dataset, 2024
- Spanish NLP Collections, hf.co/somosnlp, 2024 -
- **Foundation Model Transparency Assessment**, 2024
- Hugging Face NLP course, Org & Translator, 2023-24
- **BigScience**, Data team, Researcher, 2021-22
- BERTIN, Core team, Researcher, 2021-22

Volunteering

- **EACL** Diversity & Inclusion Chair, Aug-Apr 2025
- **ACL & COLM** Birds-of-a-Feather Organizer, 2025
- 30x speaker, mentor or hackathon judge, 2021 - Today
- Reviewer : ARR, Journal Royal Society Open Science

Languages

- Spanish : C2, Native
- English : C2, TOEFL : 114/120 (Dec 2024)
- French : C1, Official School of Languages
- German : B1, Official School of Languages